Palestinian security officials. Alarmingly, though, many of those are disaffected militants from Hamas and Islamic Jihad. They have fired rockets at Israel more than a dozen times since the 2014 ceasefire, suggesting that they have at least some access to weapons. “They’re angry that the factions didn’t continue the war. They have this idea that we should have no agreements with Israel,” a member of Islamic Jihad’s military wing told me the following summer.

On the Israeli side, too, the constant wars are having an impact. Obviously there are tangible, physical effects. Seventy-two Israelis were killed during the 2014 war. In a small, close-knit society, their deaths touched thousands of families. The mobilization of tens of thousands of reservists damaged the Israeli economy, as did the abrupt cancellation of the summer tourist season, particularly the suspended flights, which also had a psychological impact—a country briefly losing its only real exit to the outside world. But the sharpest impact is political and social. The never-ending conflict continues to poison the relationship between the Jewish majority and the Arab minority. Perhaps more significantly, it continues to empower an aggressive strain of Jewish nationalism. You could hear it on the streets, in the intolerance for dissent and the lack of empathy for suffering on the Palestinian side. And you see it in the polls, which reflect a steady erosion in support for talks (or any sort of settlement) with the Palestinians.

Just as striking, though, was the speed with which the war disappeared from public discourse. When Israelis went to the ballot box, nine months later, it was barely mentioned. Instead the country turned back to arguing over its own equally intractable internal problems.